

# Forward plan background (bring-up-to-speed)

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**Date:** 2026-06-15 (PD12 ladder patch 12:00)

**From:** COMPASS

**To:** Charles Levine

**Status:** Temporary reader's guide — you do not need to read Round 1–5 correspondence files to move forward.

**Reading order + glossary:** [forward\\_plan\\_reading\\_guide.md](#) — **start here if shorthand loses you**

**Canonical action doc:** [20260615\\_1045\\_COMPASS\\_to\\_Charles\\_forward\\_plan\\_and\\_questions.md](#)

**PD12 reassessment:** [20260615\\_1200\\_COMPASS\\_PD12\\_reassessment.md](#) — read **after** action doc + PD12 guidance (see reading guide)

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## What you were trying to do

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You felt **lost in the sauce** — too many threads (Army, basketball, tenure, generative model, predictions, Wang, planner queues, etc.). You ran an **agent correspondence experiment**: route questions, have agents reply in [3-Master\\_Plan/](#), keep going until everyone agreed on the science and was **waiting on you**, not on each other.

**That worked.** The experiment is **complete**. The output you actually need is the forward plan doc linked above. This file is the plain-English version of that plus the rounds.

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## The one sentence version

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*You have a cross-domain empirical finding, a candidate minimal mechanism, two named predictions, and a claim table — and the only blockers now are your locks, SCOUT packaging one export folder, and VECTOR writing the paper.*

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## The scientific story (what everyone agreed on)

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### 1. The finding (Tier 1 — done)

Across very different systems, **how good your local peer pool is** relates to **advancement** in a **nonlinear** way: modest pools can help, very elite pools can hurt (inverted-U with an elite-tier dip).

| Setting    | Status                                                                      |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Army       | Strong — mature empirical work                                              |
| Basketball | Strong — replicated                                                         |
| Tenure     | <b>Preliminary</b> — stage 9 figure is OK for draft with honest limitations |

## 2. The minimal mechanism (Tier 2 — close enough to write)

Not a huge realistic simulation of everything. The **minimal** story:

*Advancement propensity*  $\approx$  **Ability – Congestion** (with soft assignment / finite slots).

**Talent-only** selection **fails** — it cannot produce the inverted-U story by itself.

**Path II** (locked): Basketball runs a small **generative proof-of-concept** on this. Army and tenure do **not** need matching generative sims for v1. Army and tenure are **empirical legs** at different maturity.

**Important honesty:** The generative POC is demonstrated on **pool mean**, not a bin-for-bin replay of the **LOO pool quality** empirical axis. That is **not** a blocker — it must be stated clearly in the paper.

### 2.5. Model-guided empirical features (Rung 2.5 — PD12 Priority 3)

Alex’s May 20 guidance: the theory should **propose new measurements**, not only fit old curves.

| Construct                | Basketball                   | Army                               | Tenure                                   |
|--------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Team quality $\bar{a}_t$ | <code>poolq_loo</code>       | Pool minus mean                    | <code>poolq_loo_mean</code>              |
| Congestion $C_{i,t}$     | <code>crowding_smooth</code> | Pool size / $\Lambda$ hook (prose) | <code>pool_size_oa_loo</code> (on panel) |

**Status:** Mostly **already built** in SCOUT pipeline. D10 exports + VECTOR §3 prose make this stage explicit — **not** a new workstream.

## 3. Predictions (Tier 3 — named, not all fully tested)

**Wang move:** the model should predict something you **did not** use to find the curve — and predictions should **test** the model-guided measurements (especially quality vs congestion).

| #  | Prediction                                                                               | Where it lives                                                                                            |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| #1 | Near-threshold heterogeneity — elite-pool dip <b>strongest for borderline</b> performers | SCOUT has basketball export; Army can support analogously                                                 |
| #2 | Peak shift with global $\Lambda$ (distinction / slot capacity)                           | <b>Army-led prose</b> ; conceptual hook, <b>no finished <math>\Lambda</math>-sweep figure</b> in repo yet |

4. The paper (Tier 4 — next)

Wang structure (PD12-aligned): phenomenon → minimal mechanism → **model-guided features** → predictions → limitations.

- **Paper first**, dissertation packaging second
- **Dakota v03** = section spine
- VECTOR filed a **claim language table** — what you may and may not say (supported / preliminary / unsupported)

What happened in Rounds 1–5 (you can skip the files)

| Round | What happened                                                                                                                               |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1     | Inventory: Jun 11 COMPASS→agent Q&A all answered. First cross-agent pings. Gap: SCOUT closure checklist missing.                            |
| 2     | SCOUT filed <b>minimal model closure</b> (green/yellow/red checklist). PEER/CODA supplied cross-domain rows. VECTOR still owed claim table. |
| 3     | VECTOR filed <b>claim language table</b> + M1–M5 sign-off (no agent conflicts). Everyone aligned on Path II.                                |
| 4     | Status round — nothing new on disk; waiting on you + VECTOR STANDING BY.                                                                    |
| 5     | <b>STANDING BY</b> protocol: each agent lists final questions for <b>you only</b> . All five filed.                                         |
| After | COMPASS merged everything into the <b>forward plan</b> doc.                                                                                 |

**Reading strategy the agents validated:** Rounds 1–2 needed full-folder reads; after that, **hub + delta** was enough. You only need the **forward plan** unless you want forensic detail.

## What each agent is doing now

| Agent               | Status            | Waiting on you for                                                            |
|---------------------|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CODA (Army)         | STANDING BY       | AWS figure list, Alex (estimand, TB-stratify), optional $\Lambda$ stub yes/no |
| PEER (Tenure)       | STANDING BY       | <b>C1–C2</b> (OpenAlex tier + CSV names)                                      |
| SCOUT (Basketball)  | STANDING BY       | <b>D10 go</b> + bundle folder path                                            |
| VECTOR (Manuscript) | STANDING BY       | Confirm manuscript priority; draft after D10 + C1–C2                          |
| COMPASS             | Done synthesizing | Your Tier 1 answers                                                           |

No agent is waiting on another agent for science or planning.

## Jargon cheat sheet

| Term        | Plain English                                                                                                                               |
|-------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| D10         | SCOUT <b>packages</b> manuscript artifacts into one folder (figures, axis table, score one-pager, manifest) — ~1–2 sessions, no new science |
| M4          | "Any fights left between agents?" VECTOR said <b>no</b>                                                                                     |
| Path II     | Empirical U on LOO axis + basketball generative POC on pool mean + honest axis mismatch                                                     |
| Layer B     | Tenure Cox cells (10–12) — <b>pre-submission</b> , not draft blocker                                                                        |
| C1–C2       | Tenure inference policy: which OpenAlex tiers, which CSV filenames                                                                          |
| Claim table | VECTOR's cheat sheet for what the manuscript may claim                                                                                      |

## What you should do next (minimal path)

You do **not** need to read 60 files. Answer **Tier 1** (or paste the batch in §7 of the forward plan):

- Q-SCOUT-9** — bundle path → default `datasets/mbb/exports_inverted_u_v0/scout_manuscript_v1/`
- Q-D10** — **go** on SCOUT export bundle
- C1** — HIGH + MEDIUM OpenAlex for tenure inference

4. **C2** — `R1_tenure_data.csv` + `faculty_panel_inference_v1.csv`
5. **C12–C13, V1–V3** — confirm predictions, outline, manuscript-first focus
6. **Q-DEFAULTS** — “use agent defaults” for softer Tier 2 items

Then:

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SCOUT → build D10 bundle
PEER → inference CSV after C1–C2
VECTOR → start drafting §2, §5; then §1, §3, §4 when artifacts land
You → schedule Alex for Army estimand + TB-stratify (Tier 3)
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## What you can safely ignore until later

- 525 / UIC work (tabled)
- Pool-size audit (pre-publication)
- Tenure Layer B Cox (pre-submission)
- Generative LOO bin-for-bin match
- Network extensions, assortativity as primary prediction
- Canonical Army figure filenames (until AWS sync)
- Most Round 1–5 ping files (archaeology only)

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## If you read only a few more files

Full order: see [reading guide](#) (print this with doc 1).

1. [Forward plan](#) — where you are + your questions in order (**before** PD12 reassessment)
2. [PD12 guidance](#) — Alex’s four priorities
3. [PD12 reassessment](#) — ladder relabel
4. [VECTOR claim table](#) — §F “Do Say / Do Not Say”
5. [SCOUT closure](#) — §7 one sentence for Alex

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## The center of gravity

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Phenomenon → Minimal model → Model-guided features → Prediction → Paper
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**PD12 what we deliver in v1:** Priority 3 (congestion / model-guided features) + partial Priority 2 (talent-only fail).

**PD12 what we defer (say so to Alex):** Priority 1 (3-domain identifiability), Priority 4 (fourth-domain falsification).

The planner and rounds were **coordination**, not new science. The science was already moving; you needed a **shared stop rule** and **one ordered question list for you**. The June 15 PD12 reassessment adds **explicit middle rungs** so the plan matches Alex's progression without expanding scope.

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*Temporary background doc. Delete or archive when no longer needed.*